



भारत में महिलाओं के विरुद्ध अपराध Crimes Against Women in India

Empowering Women Through Data
बेटी बचाओ बेटी पढ़ाओ

धीरेन्द्र सिंह द्वारा तैयार
PREPARED BY DHIRENDRA SINGH

Statistical & Analytical Report on Crimes Against Women
(2001–2023)

भारत सरकार
Government of India

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Disclaimer

This report is an independent academic and data analytics project created using publicly available NCRB and Government of India datasets. This document is not an official publication of the Government of India, NCRB, or Ministry of Home Affairs.

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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Crime against women in India has been a persistent social challenge spanning decades. This report presents a comprehensive data-driven analysis of 22+ years of official crime statistics sourced from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), covering all 36 States and Union Territories of India. The analysis encompasses 15 datasets, 7 cleaned data files, and 18 original visualizations presented through an interactive Power BI dashboard and this comprehensive report.

Between 2001 and 2021, a total of 48,67,722 crimes against women were reported across India, with an average annual crime count of approximately 2,32,749 cases. Over the two-decade period, crimes against women increased by 170.8%, highlighting a significant rise in reported incidents and enforcement activity. The analysis covers 36 States and Union Territories, examining 8 major categories of crimes against women across more than 1,140 districts nationwide.

1.1 CRITICAL FINDINGS

i. Significant Growth in Crimes Against Women

Crimes against women in India increased dramatically over the last two decades, recording a growth of **170.8%** between 2001 and 2021. Reported cases rose from **1,28,537 cases in 2001** to **3,48,092 cases in 2021**, indicating a substantial escalation in crime reporting, awareness, and law-enforcement registration mechanisms across the country.

ii. Domestic Violence Emerged as the Most Prevalent Crime

Among all analyzed crime categories, **Domestic Violence (Cruelty by Husband or Relatives)** accounted for the largest share of reported crimes against women. The category contributed approximately **39.2% of the total crimes**, with a cumulative count of **19,09,978 reported cases**, making it the most dominant and persistent form of violence against women during the study period.

iii. Uttar Pradesh Recorded the Highest Crime Volume

State-wise analysis revealed that **Uttar Pradesh** consistently reported the highest number of crimes against women in India. Between 2001 and 2021, the state registered a cumulative total of **5,29,734 reported cases**, reflecting a significantly higher crime burden compared to other states and union territories.

iv. Post-Nirbhaya Incident Reporting Surge

The **Nirbhaya case of December 2012** marked a critical turning point in women-safety awareness and crime reporting across India. Following the incident, crimes against women witnessed a sharp rise in registration and reporting, with an estimated **46.8% increase in reported cases during the subsequent years**. The event significantly influenced public awareness, legal reforms, media attention, and policing intensity nationwide.

v. Murshidabad Identified as the Most Crime-Affected District

District-level analysis identified **Murshidabad district in West Bengal** as the most crime-affected district in the country. Between 2001 and 2022, the district recorded a cumulative total of **37,010 crimes against women**, placing it at the highest position among all analyzed districts nationwide.

vi. **Karnataka Reported Highest Cyber Crimes Against Women**

In the category of **Cyber Crimes Against Women**, **Karnataka** emerged as the leading state in 2023. The state reported **7,002 cyber crime cases against women**, highlighting the rapid growth of technology-enabled harassment, online exploitation, and cyber abuse targeting women in recent years.



2.INTRODUCTION

Crime against women in India encompasses a wide spectrum of offenses from domestic violence and dowry deaths to rape, kidnapping, and the emerging threat of cyber crimes. Despite significant legislative reforms, including the Criminal Law Amendment Act (2013) following the Nirbhaya case, crime statistics continue to paint a deeply concerning picture. The National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), operating under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, systematically collects and publishes annual crime statistics making it the most authoritative source for understanding crime patterns in India.

2.1 Problem Statement

While individual annual reports provide year-specific data, a comprehensive longitudinal analysis spanning 22+ years has been lacking. This project addresses that gap by: - Consolidating 15 datasets from multiple official sources - Analyzing temporal and geographic crime patterns - Measuring judicial performance through arrest rate analysis - Identifying emerging threats like cyber crimes against women

2.2 Objectives

- i. **To Analyze Year-wise Crime Trends Against Women in India (2001–2023)**
The study aims to examine the year-wise progression of crimes against women in India from 2001 to 2023 in order to understand long-term trends, fluctuations, and growth patterns. The analysis focuses on identifying major inflection points, sudden increases or decreases in reported crimes, and socio-political events that may have influenced crime reporting and enforcement activity during the study period.
- ii. **To Identify High-Crime States and Districts Requiring Priority Intervention**
This study seeks to identify the states and districts with the highest concentration of crimes against women through cumulative and comparative analysis. The objective is to highlight geographic regions requiring urgent policy attention, stronger law-enforcement mechanisms, improved women-safety infrastructure, and targeted administrative intervention for crime prevention and victim protection.
- iii. **To Evaluate Judicial and Enforcement Performance Through Arrest Analysis**
The study aims to assess judicial and law-enforcement effectiveness by analyzing arrest trends and arrest rates across major crime categories between 2001 and 2012. This objective focuses on understanding how enforcement intensity evolved over time and whether increasing crime rates were accompanied by proportional increases in arrests and policing actions.
- iv. **To Examine the Distribution and Dominance of Crime Categories**

The objective of this analysis is to evaluate the distribution of different crime categories against women and identify the most prevalent forms of violence. The study examines major crime heads such as Domestic Violence, Rape, Kidnapping & Abduction, Dowry Deaths, Assault on Women, Trafficking, and Cyber Crimes in order to understand the relative contribution and severity of each category.

v. To Analyze Emerging Cyber Crime Patterns Against Women in 2023

The study also focuses on understanding the growing threat of cyber crimes against women in India during 2023. This objective aims to identify high-risk states, analyze the rise of technology-enabled harassment and online exploitation, and evaluate emerging digital crime patterns affecting women in the modern cyber environment.

2.3 Significance

i. Provides a Comprehensive 22-Year Analytical Perspective

This study presents one of the most comprehensive long-term analyses of crimes against women in India using NCRB data spanning from 2001 to 2023. By integrating multi-year statistical records into a single analytical framework, the report enables a deeper understanding of crime trends, reporting patterns, regional variations, and the evolving nature of crimes against women over two decades.

ii. Identifies Geographic Hotspots for Targeted Policy Intervention

The analysis systematically identifies high-crime states and districts across India through state-wise and district-wise crime assessment. By highlighting regions with consistently high crime concentration, the study supports targeted policy formulation, focused administrative action, improved policing strategies, and efficient allocation of women-safety resources in vulnerable areas.

iii. Bridges the Gap Between Raw Data and Actionable Insights

Government crime datasets often remain underutilized due to their complexity and fragmented structure. This study transforms raw NCRB statistical data into meaningful analytical insights through data visualization, trend analysis, comparative evaluation, and enforcement assessment. The report simplifies large-scale crime data into interpretable findings that can support evidence-based decision-making and strategic planning.

iv. Supports Researchers, Policymakers, and Civil Society Organizations

The study serves as a valuable reference document for researchers, public policy analysts, government institutions, law-enforcement agencies, and civil society organizations working in the domain of women's safety and gender justice. The findings can assist stakeholders in understanding crime dynamics, evaluating policy effectiveness, and developing informed interventions aimed at improving women's safety across India.

v. Highlights Emerging Challenges in Women Safety

In addition to conventional crime categories, the report also emphasizes emerging threats such as cyber crimes against women, technology-enabled harassment, and digital exploitation. This makes the study relevant in the context of evolving social and technological environments, where crimes against women are increasingly shifting toward online and cyber platforms.

vi. Encourages Data-Driven Governance and Public Awareness

By combining statistical analysis with interactive visualization and dashboard-based reporting, the study promotes the use of data-driven governance approaches in addressing women-safety issues. The report also contributes to public awareness by presenting crime data in a clear, accessible, and research-oriented format that encourages informed discussion and policy dialogue.

3. DATA SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

3.1 Data Sources

This study utilizes a total of 15 CSV datasets collected from three official and publicly accessible data platforms in order to ensure the reliability, authenticity, and comprehensiveness of the analysis. The datasets primarily focus on crimes against women in India and include state-wise, district-wise, and category-wise crime statistics spanning more than two decades

Source 1: National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB)

The primary source of data for this study is the National Crime Records Bureau, operating under the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India. Official crime statistics were collected from the NCRB annual crime reports available through the official website:

The datasets include State and Union Territory-wise crime statistics related to crimes against women across multiple crime categories. A total of 10 datasets covering the period from 2001 to 2023 were utilized for longitudinal trend analysis, comparative state-level assessment, and enforcement evaluation.

Source 2: data.gov.in

Additional datasets were obtained from the Government of India's Open Government Data platform:

These datasets primarily contain district-wise crime statistics and detailed state-level breakdowns of crimes against women. The data covers the period from 2001 to 2022 and includes 4 structured datasets used for district-level analysis, hotspot identification, and geographic crime distribution assessment across India.

Source 3: Mendeley Data Repository

To support consolidated analytical processing and validation, one pre-compiled NCRB dataset was collected from the Mendeley Data Repository:

The dataset includes integrated crime statistics spanning from 2001 to 2022 and was used as a supplementary source for cross-verification, preprocessing efficiency, and analytical consistency during dashboard development and trend analysis.

Data Accessibility & Government Policy Compliance

All datasets used in this study are publicly accessible and published under the National Data Sharing and Accessibility Policy (NDSAP) of the Government of India. The policy promotes transparency, accessibility, and responsible utilization of public-sector data for research, policy development, analytics, and public awareness initiatives. The use of official government datasets ensures the authenticity, credibility, and institutional reliability of the findings presented in this report.

3.2 Data Description

3.2.1 Primary Dataset Overview

The primary dataset used in this study consists of 736 rows and 10 columns containing structured crime-related information associated with crimes against women in India. The dataset covers a continuous period from 2001 to 2021, enabling long-term trend analysis, comparative assessment, and temporal evaluation of crime patterns over two decades. Data has been collected for all 36 States and Union Territories, ensuring comprehensive nationwide analytical coverage. Each record represents state-wise and year-wise crime statistics categorized under major crime heads, making the dataset suitable for state-level comparison, district-level analysis, enforcement evaluation, and crime trend visualization.

3.2.2 Crime Categories Covered

a) Rape (IPC Section 376)

This category includes crimes registered under Section 376 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC) involving sexual assault and non-consensual acts against women. It represents one of the most severe forms of violence against women analyzed in this study.

b) Kidnapping & Abduction

This category covers cases involving unlawful kidnapping, abduction, forced movement, coercion, illegal confinement, and related offenses committed against women and girls across different regions of India.

c) Dowry Deaths (IPC Section 304B)

This category includes deaths of married women resulting from dowry-related harassment, abuse, or violence. The crimes are registered under IPC Section 304B and reflect the continuing social issue of dowry-related violence in India.

d) Assault on Women (IPC Section 354)

This category includes cases registered under IPC Section 354, involving assault or criminal force intended to harass, intimidate, or violate the dignity and safety of women.

e) Outrage of Women's Modesty

This category includes offenses intended to insult or outrage the modesty of women through inappropriate physical behavior, verbal harassment, intimidation, or related actions affecting women's dignity and public safety.

f) Cruelty by Husband or Relatives (IPC Section 498A)

This category includes crimes registered under IPC Section 498A, covering mental and physical cruelty, harassment, abuse, and violence committed by husbands or their relatives against married women.

g) Domestic Violence

This category includes incidents of physical, emotional, psychological, verbal, and economic abuse occurring within domestic environments and family settings affecting women across various socio-economic backgrounds.

h) Women Trafficking

This category includes crimes related to trafficking, exploitation, forced labor, illegal transportation, sexual exploitation, and organized criminal activities involving women and girls.

3.2.3 Data Cleaning Process

Step 1 Data Collection

The initial stage of the study involved collecting raw datasets from multiple official government data platforms. A total of 15 CSV files containing crime statistics related to women were downloaded from sources including the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), data.gov.in, and other publicly accessible repositories. These datasets included state-wise, district-wise, and category-wise crime records spanning multiple years.

Step 2 Initial Inspection

After data collection, all datasets underwent an initial inspection process to evaluate their structure and quality. This included examining column names, identifying data types, checking dataset dimensions, detecting missing values, and understanding inconsistencies across files. The inspection process helped identify formatting irregularities and potential data-quality issues before preprocessing and analytical operations were performed.

Step 3 Data Standardization

To ensure consistency across all datasets, a comprehensive standardization process was carried out. Column names were unified across files to maintain a common schema for analytical processing. State and Union Territory names were standardized to eliminate inconsistencies and duplicate representations, such as converting “Delhi UT” into a unified format like “DELHI”. Additionally, all year columns were converted into a consistent integer format to support accurate chronological analysis and visualization.

Step 4 Removing Aggregate Records

Aggregate summary rows such as “TOTAL (ALL-INDIA)”, “TOTAL (STATES)”, and “TOTAL (UTs)” were removed from the datasets before analysis. These aggregate records significantly inflated statistical values when combined with state-level data and could distort analytical results by approximately three to five times if not properly filtered. Removing these rows ensured the accuracy and reliability of state-wise and district-wise analysis.

Step 5 Data Type Conversion

All crime-count columns were converted into numeric data types to enable statistical analysis and visualization. During this process, non-numeric entries, formatting errors, and invalid values were handled using coercion techniques to avoid processing failures and maintain dataset consistency. This step ensured compatibility with analytical tools such as Python, Pandas, and Power BI.

Step 6 Feature Engineering

A new analytical feature named “**Total_Crimes**” was created by summing all eight major crime categories for each state-year combination. This derived metric enabled cumulative trend analysis, comparative ranking, and overall crime assessment across states, districts, and time periods. Feature engineering also improved the efficiency of dashboard calculations and KPI generation.

Step 7 Data Validation

The cleaned datasets were validated by cross-verifying aggregated values and yearly totals with officially published NCRB annual reports. This validation process ensured that the transformed datasets accurately reflected the original government statistics and maintained analytical reliability throughout the study.

Final Output

After completing the cleaning, preprocessing, and validation stages, a total of **7 clean and analysis-ready CSV files** were generated and stored for downstream analytical tasks. These processed datasets were subsequently used for statistical analysis, trend evaluation, dashboard development, visualization, and report generation throughout the project.

3.2.4 Tools & Technologies

This study utilized a combination of modern data-processing, visualization, and business-intelligence tools to perform large-scale analytical operations and develop an interactive reporting system. **Python 3.9** served as the primary programming language for data preprocessing and analysis, while libraries such as **Pandas 2.0** and **NumPy** were used for data manipulation, cleaning, transformation, and numerical computations. The analytical workflow was executed using **Google Colab**, which provided a cloud-based notebook environment for scalable data analysis.

For visualization and exploratory analysis, **Matplotlib** and **Seaborn** were used to create statistical plots, trend charts, and analytical graphics, resulting in the development of **18 original visualizations**. The interactive analytical dashboard was developed using **Microsoft Power BI Desktop**, featuring a **4-page dynamic dashboard** with filters, cross-filtering functionality, **KPI cards**, and **DAX-based calculations** for advanced analytical insights.

Additionally, **Canva** was used for professional report design and presentation formatting, while GitHub was utilized for version control, project organization, and maintaining the analytical workflow and datasets throughout the study.

4. MAIN ANALYSIS (2001-2021)

4.1 Year-wise Crime Trend

The 21-year longitudinal analysis of crimes against women in India reveals a clear and consistent upward trajectory in reported crime cases between 2001 and 2021. The analysis began with **1,28,537 reported cases in 2001**, which served as the baseline year for trend evaluation. The lowest number of reported cases during the study period was recorded in **2003 with 1,28,142 cases**, after which crime levels began to rise steadily across the country.

A major statistical milestone was observed in **2010**, when total reported crimes against women crossed the **2 lakh mark**, reaching **2,00,534 cases** for the first time. By **2012**, the number of reported crimes increased further to **2,35,025 cases**, marking a critical year in India's women-safety landscape due to the Nirbhaya incident in December 2012.

Following the Nirbhaya case, India witnessed a substantial increase in crime reporting, public awareness, media attention, and legislative reforms related to women's safety. As a result, reported crimes surged sharply, reaching **3,33,216 cases in 2014**, which represented one of the most significant post-reform spikes in the dataset. Although a temporary decline was observed in **2020**, where reported crimes dropped to **3,02,166 cases** during the COVID-19 pandemic and nationwide lockdowns, the numbers rose again in **2021**, reaching **3,48,092 cases**, the highest recorded figure during the study period.



4.1.1 Key Observations

Phase 1 (2001–2007): Gradual Rise

During the initial phase from 2001 to 2007, crimes against women increased gradually at an estimated annual growth rate of approximately 4%. The trend indicates relatively stable but persistent levels of violence against women across the country, with slow but continuous growth in reported cases.

Phase 2 (2008–2012): Accelerated Growth

Between 2008 and 2012, the growth rate accelerated significantly, eventually reaching 2,35,025 reported cases in 2012. This period reflects increasing crime registration, urbanization-related challenges, and growing public visibility of women-safety issues. The Nirbhaya incident in December 2012 became a watershed moment in India's criminal justice and women-safety discourse.

Phase 3 (2013–2021): Sharp Post-Nirbhaya Surge

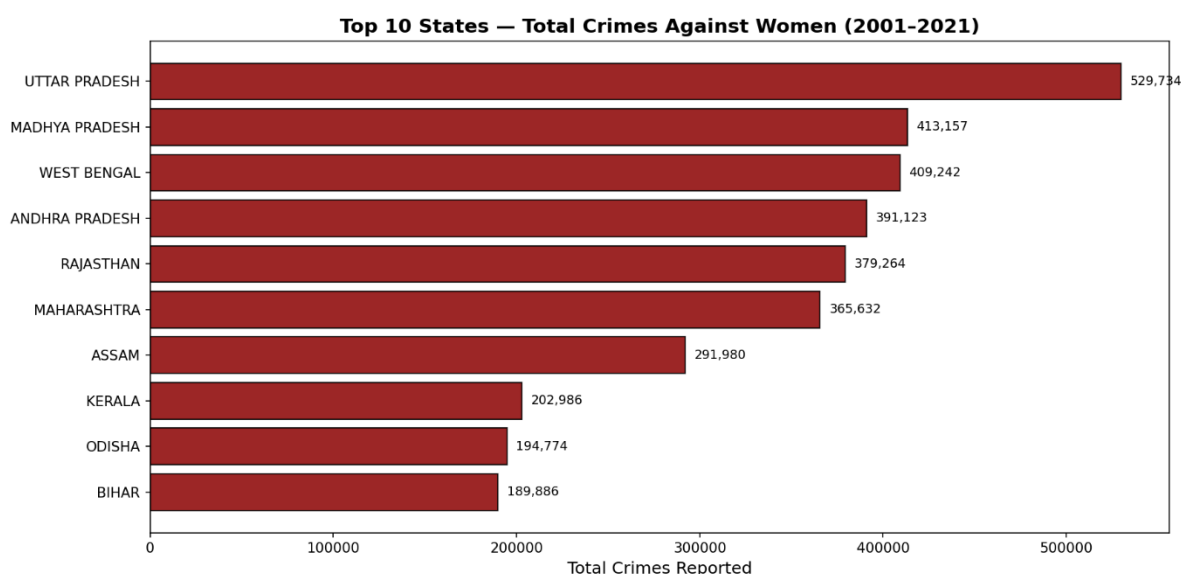
The period from 2013 to 2021 witnessed a sharp surge in reported crimes against women following post-Nirbhaya legislative reforms, increased public awareness, media attention, and improved reporting mechanisms. During this phase, annual reported crimes averaged more than 3,20,000 cases, indicating both heightened crime reporting and intensified societal focus on women's safety and justice mechanisms across India.

4.2 State-wise Analysis

State-wise analysis revealed that **Uttar Pradesh** recorded the highest number of crimes against women in India during the study period from 2001 to 2021. The state registered a cumulative total of **5,29,734 reported cases**, contributing approximately **10.9% of the national total crimes against women** during the 21-year analysis period. Uttar Pradesh consistently ranked as the highest crime-reporting state throughout the study, maintaining the number one position across all years of analysis.

The broader state-level assessment identified five major states that collectively accounted for a substantial proportion of crimes against women in India. Following Uttar Pradesh, **Madhya Pradesh** recorded **4,13,157 cases**, while **West Bengal** reported **4,09,242 cases** during the same period. **Andhra Pradesh** registered **3,91,123 cases**, and **Rajasthan** recorded **3,79,264 cases** between 2001 and 2021.

Together, these five states contributed approximately **43.2% of all reported crimes against women nationwide**, indicating a significant geographic concentration of crime incidents in specific regions of the country. The findings highlight the urgent need for targeted policy intervention, stronger law-enforcement mechanisms, and region-specific women-safety

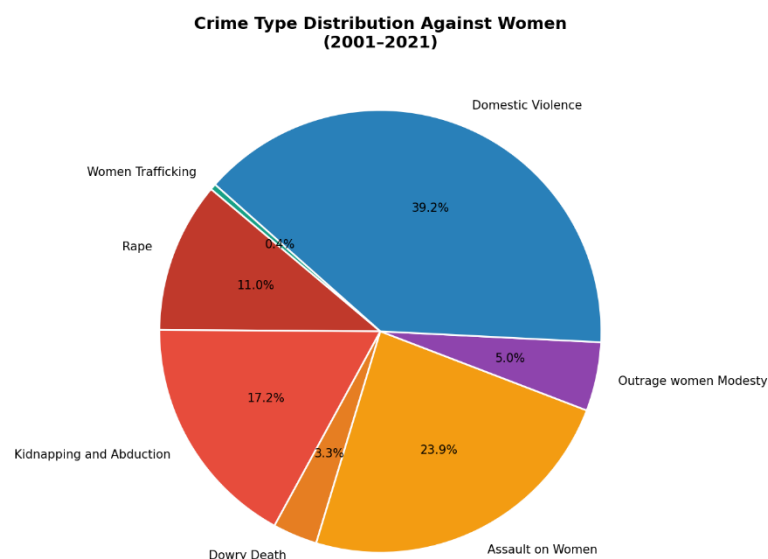


4.3 Crime Type Distribution

The analysis of crime-category distribution reveals that Domestic Violence (Cruelty by Husband or Relatives) is the most dominant form of crime against women in India during the study period from 2001 to 2021. The category accounted for approximately 39.2% of all reported crimes against women, with a cumulative total of 19,09,978 reported cases. The findings indicate that nearly two out of every five crimes against women in India were related to domestic abuse, highlighting the widespread prevalence of violence within household environments.

A detailed distribution of major crime categories is presented below:

- **Domestic Violence** accounted for **39.2%** of total crimes, with approximately **1.9 million reported cases**, making it the largest and most persistent category throughout the study period.
- **Assault on Women** represented **23.9%** of the total crimes, contributing nearly **1.2 million cases** nationwide. This category includes physical assault, harassment, and criminal force against women.
- **Kidnapping & Abduction** contributed **17.2%** of total reported crimes, with approximately **0.8 million cases**, reflecting significant concerns related to forced movement, coercion, trafficking, and abduction of women and girls
- **Rape cases** accounted for **11.0%** of the overall crime distribution, contributing nearly **0.5 million reported incidents** during the analysis period.
- **Outrage of Women's Modesty** represented approximately **5.0%** of total crimes, with nearly **0.2 million reported cases** involving harassment and acts affecting women's dignity and public safety.
- **Dowry Deaths**, registered under IPC Section 304B, contributed **3.3%** of the total crime share, highlighting the continuing social issue of dowry-related violence and abuse against married women.
- **Women Trafficking** constituted approximately **0.4%** of total reported crimes, with nearly **21,000 cases**, representing organized exploitation and trafficking-related offenses against women and girls.



4.3.1 Key Observation

The overwhelming dominance of **Domestic Violence at 39.2%** is particularly alarming, as it suggests that the household environment traditionally considered a place of safety and protection has emerged as one of the most dangerous spaces for women in India. The findings indicate that a substantial proportion of violence against women originates from intimate or familial relationships rather than public spaces alone. This highlights the urgent need for stronger domestic protection mechanisms, legal support systems, awareness programs, and targeted policy interventions focused on household-level violence prevention and women's safety.

4.4 Nirbhaya Effect Analysis

The Nirbhaya incident of December 2012 marked a major turning point in India's women-safety discourse, criminal justice system, and crime-reporting behavior. To understand its impact, the study compares crime trends against women during the periods before and after the incident.

Before Nirbhaya (2001–2012)

During the pre-Nirbhaya period from 2001 to 2012, India recorded a cumulative total of **19,72,456 crimes against women**, with an average of approximately **1,64,371 cases per year**. Although crime levels were steadily increasing during this phase, reporting patterns remained relatively moderate due to limited public awareness, social stigma, underreporting, and weaker institutional focus on women's safety issues.

After Nirbhaya (2013–2021)

In the post-Nirbhaya period from 2013 to 2021, the total reported crimes against women increased significantly to **28,95,266 cases**, with the annual average rising sharply to approximately **3,21,696 cases per year**. This period witnessed heightened public awareness, stronger media coverage, major legislative reforms, and increased societal attention toward crimes against women across India.

Key Statistical Observation

- **Total Crimes Before Nirbhaya (2001–2012):** 19,72,456
- **Average Annual Crimes Before Nirbhaya:** 1,64,371
- **Total Crimes After Nirbhaya (2013–2021):** 28,95,266
- **Average Annual Crimes After Nirbhaya:** 3,21,696
- **Overall Increase in Reported Crimes:** 46.8%

Analytical Interpretation

The observed **46.8% increase** in reported crimes against women after the Nirbhaya incident should not be interpreted solely as a proportional increase in actual criminal activity. A substantial portion of the rise can also be attributed to significant improvements in crime-

reporting mechanisms, increased public awareness regarding women's rights, expanded media attention, stronger legal protections, and reduced social stigma associated with filing complaints.

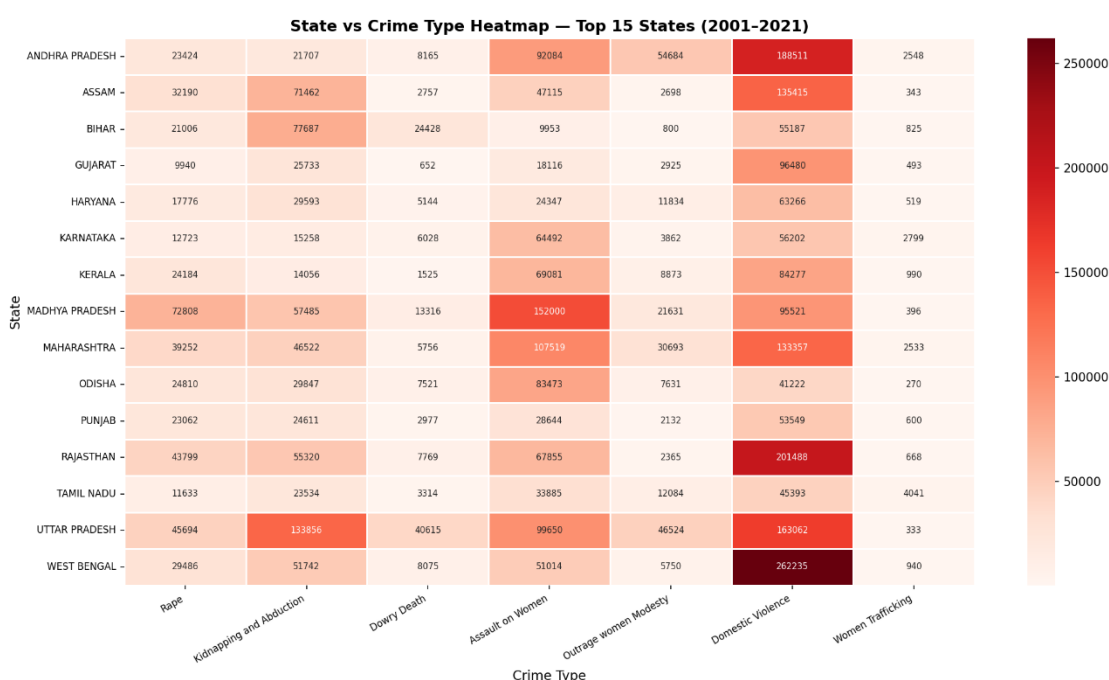
The Nirbhaya case triggered nationwide protests, policy reforms, and amendments to criminal laws, including the **Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013**, which strengthened legal provisions related to sexual offenses and women's safety. As a result, women became comparatively more willing to report incidents of violence and harassment to law-enforcement agencies.

The analysis therefore suggests that the post-2012 rise in reported crimes reflects both an increase in reporting efficiency and greater societal recognition of crimes against women, in addition to underlying crime trends.

5. STATE LEVEL ANALYSIS

5.1 Crime Intensity Heatmap

The state-wise crime intensity heatmap reveals significant regional variations in the distribution of crimes against women across India. The visualization highlights concentration patterns for different crime categories and identifies states with persistently high crime intensity during the analysis period from 2001 to 2021. The findings indicate that certain states consistently dominate specific categories of crimes against women, reflecting varying socio-economic conditions, reporting behavior, policing efficiency, and regional enforcement challenges.



West Bengal (Highest Domestic Violence Cases)

The heatmap analysis identified **West Bengal** as the state with the highest number of **Domestic Violence (Cruelty by Husband or Relatives)** cases in India. Between 2001 and 2021, the state recorded a cumulative total of **2,62,235 domestic violence cases**, making it the most affected state under this category. The volume of reported domestic violence cases in West Bengal was nearly **1.4 times higher than Rajasthan**, which ranked second in the category. The findings indicate a persistent and deeply rooted pattern of household-level violence requiring sustained policy intervention and social awareness initiatives.

Madhya Pradesh (Highest Rape Cases)

The analysis revealed that **Madhya Pradesh** recorded the highest number of **rape cases** during the study period, with a cumulative total of **72,808 reported incidents** between 2001 and 2021. The state consistently remained among the top contributors in crimes related to sexual violence against women throughout the analysis period. The persistent concentration

of rape cases highlights long-term challenges associated with women's safety, law enforcement effectiveness, and socio-cultural vulnerabilities within the region.

Uttar Pradesh (Highest Kidnapping & Abduction Cases)

The heatmap further identified **Uttar Pradesh** as the leading state in cases related to **Kidnapping & Abduction of women**, recording approximately **1,33,856 cumulative cases** during the analysis period. The consistently high number of kidnapping-related incidents reflects a complex combination of socio-economic pressures, population density, organized criminal activity, gender-related vulnerabilities, and law-enforcement challenges within the state. The findings emphasize the need for stronger preventive mechanisms, rapid-response systems, and targeted policing strategies to address crimes involving abduction and trafficking of women.

5.2 Before vs After Nirbhaya

The comparative analysis of crimes against women before and after the 2012 Nirbhaya incident reveals significant variation in crime trends across different Indian states. The post-Nirbhaya period witnessed major legal reforms, increased public awareness, stronger media attention, and improvements in crime-reporting mechanisms. However, the impact of these changes was not uniform across all states, resulting in distinct regional patterns of growth and decline in reported crimes against women.

States Showing Significant Increase After Nirbhaya

Several states recorded substantial increases in reported crimes against women during the post-Nirbhaya period (2013–2021) when compared to the pre-Nirbhaya phase (2001–2012).

- **Uttar Pradesh** recorded the highest increase, with reported crimes rising by approximately **40.5%** after 2012. The state continued to remain the largest contributor to crimes against women nationwide throughout the study period.
- **Madhya Pradesh** witnessed an increase of approximately **35.2%**, maintaining consistently high levels of crimes related to sexual violence and women's safety.
- **Rajasthan** recorded an estimated **19.4% increase** in reported crimes against women during the post-reform period, indicating continued upward crime trends despite heightened national attention toward women's safety issues.

The sharp increases observed in these states may reflect a combination of factors including increased reporting awareness, population growth, urbanization-related pressures, and persistent structural challenges associated with law enforcement and gender-based violence.

States Showing Decrease or Slower Growth

In contrast, certain states demonstrated either reduced crime growth or comparatively stable reporting patterns after the Nirbhaya incident.

- **Andhra Pradesh** recorded a significant decline of approximately **36.3%** in reported crimes against women during the post-Nirbhaya period, suggesting improvements in enforcement, prevention mechanisms, or changes in reporting dynamics.

- **West Bengal** showed only a marginal increase of approximately **3.2%**, indicating relatively slower growth compared to other major states analyzed in the study.

The comparatively moderate trends observed in these states suggest that post-Nirbhaya reforms, awareness campaigns, and administrative interventions may have had varying levels of effectiveness across different regions.

Key Observation

The divergence in state-wise trends indicates that the impact of the Nirbhaya reforms and women-safety initiatives was not uniform across India. While some states experienced sharp increases in reported crimes, others showed comparatively stable or declining trends. This variation highlights the importance of region-specific policy interventions, localized enforcement strategies, and state-level administrative effectiveness in addressing crimes against women across the country.

5.3 Category-wise Growth Trends

The category-wise growth analysis reveals substantial variation in the long-term progression of different crimes against women between 2001 and 2021. Certain crime categories experienced sharp increases over the two-decade period, while others remained relatively stable or even declined. These trends provide important insights into changing social dynamics, reporting behavior, legal awareness, and enforcement effectiveness across India.

5.3.1 Fastest Growing Crime Category [Cruelty by Husband or Relatives (IPC Section 498A)]

Among all analyzed crime categories, **Cruelty by Husband or Relatives (IPC Section 498A)** emerged as the fastest growing category during the study period. Reported cases increased from approximately **49,170 cases in 2001 to 1,40,019 cases in 2021**, representing an overall growth of nearly **184.8%** over two decades.

The sharp increase in cases related to domestic cruelty and marital abuse may be attributed to several interconnected factors, including:

- Greater Willingness to Report Domestic Abuse**
Women have become comparatively more willing to report incidents of domestic violence and marital cruelty due to increasing awareness, social support mechanisms, and public discussion surrounding women's rights.
- Improved Awareness of IPC Section 498A**
Increased legal awareness regarding the protections available under **IPC Section 498A** has encouraged victims to approach law-enforcement agencies and seek legal remedies against domestic abuse and harassment.
- Rising Domestic and Socio-Economic Stress Factors**
Urbanization, financial pressure, family disputes, and changing social structures may have contributed to increasing domestic tensions and conflicts within households, resulting in higher reporting of marital cruelty cases.

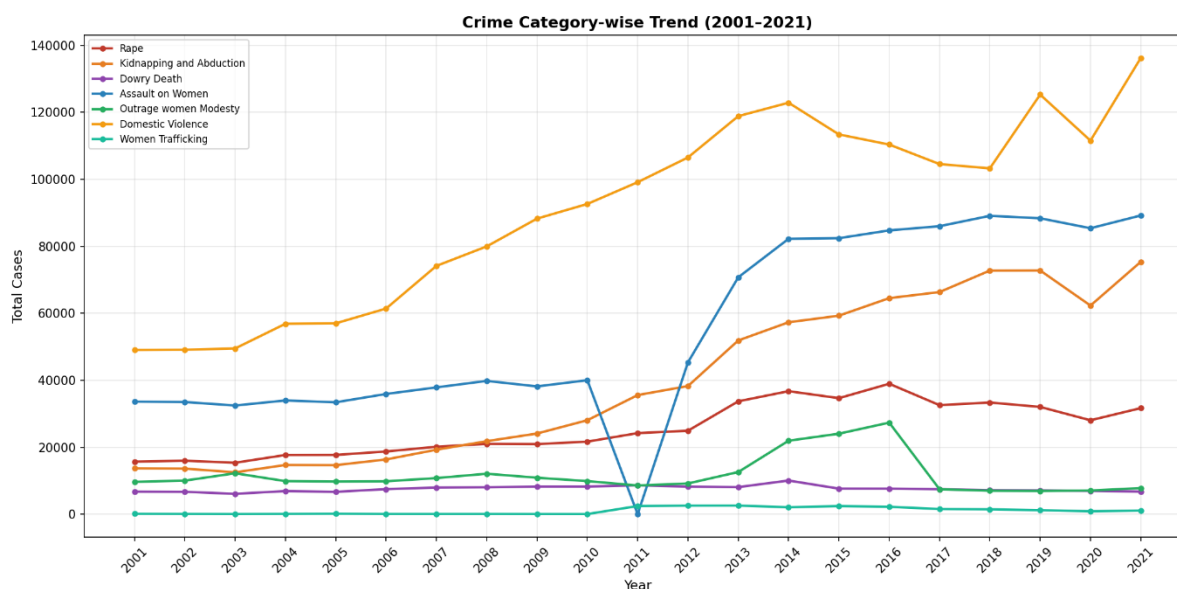
The findings indicate that domestic and household-related violence continues to remain one of the most critical women-safety challenges in India.

5.3.2 Slowest Growing Crime Category (Dowry Deaths)

In contrast to most other crime categories, **Dowry Deaths** recorded the slowest growth trend and, notably, demonstrated a slight decline over the study period. Reported dowry death cases decreased from approximately **6,851 cases in 2001** to **6,450 cases in 2021**, representing a rare overall decline of nearly **5.9%**.

The declining trend in dowry deaths may indicate gradual improvements in legal enforcement, public awareness, and social intervention mechanisms related to dowry-related violence. The implementation of stricter legal provisions under the **Dowry Prohibition Act** and increased societal attention toward dowry-related abuse may have contributed to controlling the growth of this category over time.

Although the decline remains relatively modest, the trend represents a comparatively positive development within the broader landscape of crimes against women in India.



6. DISTRICT LEVEL ANALYSIS (2001–2022)

6.1 Overview

The district-level analysis conducted in this study covers more than **1,140 unique districts** across **39 States and Union Territories of India**, utilizing crime data spanning from **2001 to 2022**. Unlike state-level analysis, which often presents aggregated crime patterns, district-level examination provides a far more granular understanding of the geographic distribution and concentration of crimes against women across the country.

The analysis reveals that crimes against women are not evenly distributed across states, but are instead highly concentrated within specific districts that emerge as major crime hotspots over time. In many cases, state-level averages tend to mask the severity of crime conditions within individual districts, resulting in an incomplete understanding of local women-safety challenges.

By examining district-wise crime patterns, the study identifies localized regions with disproportionately high crime intensity, recurring violence trends, and persistent law-enforcement challenges. This granular approach enables more accurate hotspot identification, targeted administrative intervention, district-specific policing strategies, and improved allocation of women-safety resources. The findings emphasize the importance of district-level analytics in understanding the true spatial dynamics of crimes against women in India.

6.2 Top 20 Most Dangerous Districts

The district-level crime analysis identified several districts with exceptionally high concentrations of crimes against women between 2001 and 2022. The findings reveal that a significant proportion of crimes are concentrated within a limited number of districts, highlighting severe regional imbalances in women's safety and law-enforcement effectiveness across India.

Rank 1 Murshidabad, West Bengal

Murshidabad district in West Bengal emerged as the most crime-affected district in the country during the study period. Between 2001 and 2022, the district recorded a cumulative total of approximately **37,010 crimes against women**, making it the highest-ranked district nationwide.

The district also demonstrated an alarming long-term growth trend in crime intensity. Annual crime cases increased nearly **six-fold**, rising from approximately **500 cases per year in 2001** to more than **6,000 cases annually by 2022**. The rapid escalation indicates persistent structural, socio-economic, and enforcement-related challenges affecting women's safety within the district.

Rank 2 24 Parganas South, West Bengal

The second-highest number of crimes against women was recorded in **24 Parganas South district, West Bengal**, which registered approximately **27,942 cumulative cases** during the

analysis period. The district consistently remained among the highest crime-contributing regions in the country, further reinforcing the concentration of women-safety challenges within the state of West Bengal.

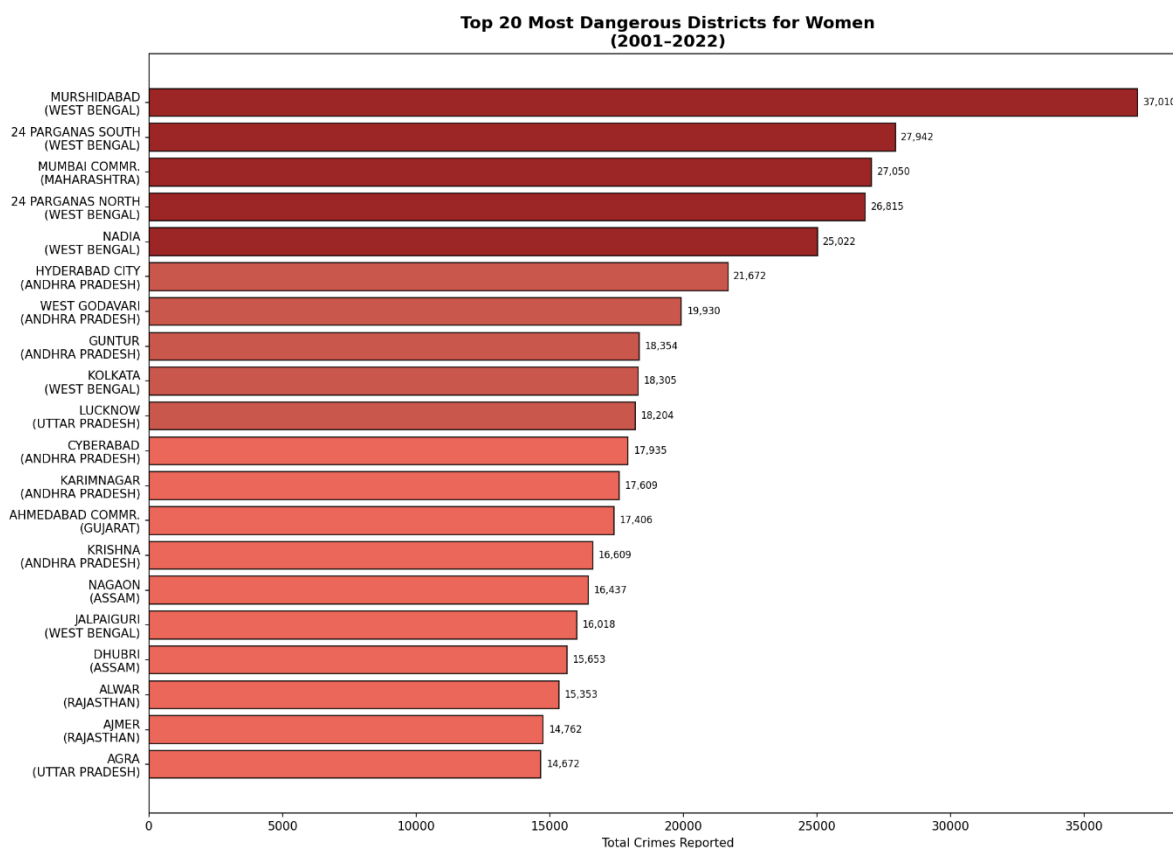
Rank 3 Mumbai Commissionerate, Maharashtra

The **Mumbai Commissionerate district in Maharashtra** ranked third nationwide, recording approximately **27,050 crimes against women** between 2001 and 2022. Unlike some traditionally high-crime districts, Mumbai demonstrated one of the fastest growth trajectories in reported crimes and eventually surpassed most districts in annual crime intensity by 2022. The findings highlight the growing urban dimension of crimes against women within densely populated metropolitan regions.

Key Observation (West Bengal Dominance)

A particularly significant finding of the district-level analysis is the overwhelming concentration of high-crime districts within **West Bengal**. The study revealed that **4 out of the Top 5 most dangerous districts in India** were located in West Bengal, indicating a severe and persistent state-level women-safety crisis.

The concentration of multiple high-risk districts within a single state suggests the presence of deep-rooted socio-economic vulnerabilities, enforcement limitations, population-density pressures, and administrative challenges related to women's safety. The findings emphasize the urgent need for targeted policy intervention, district-level policing reforms, stronger protection mechanisms, and focused women-safety programs within high-burden regions of West Bengal





Mumbai Commissionerate District (Fastest Growing Crime Trend)

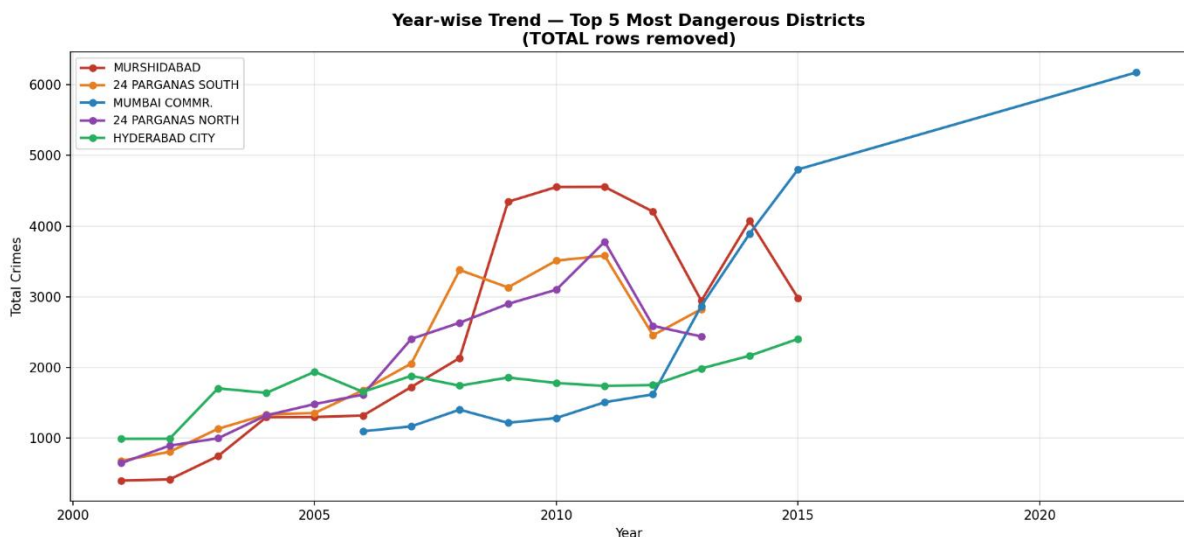
- ### Murshidabad District (Peak and Decline Pattern)

- ### Top 3 Districts per State — Crime Heatmap (2001-2022)
-
- This heatmap displays the crime rates for the top 3 districts in each state from 2001 to 2022. The color intensity represents the crime rate, with a scale from 10,000 (light yellow) to 35,000 (dark red). The districts are listed on the y-axis, and the states are listed on the x-axis. The crime rates are explicitly labeled on each cell.
- | District | State | Crime Rate |
|-------------------|----------------|------------|
| 24 PARGANAS NORTH | WEST BENGAL | 26815 |
| 24 PARGANAS SOUTH | WEST BENGAL | 27942 |
| AGRA | UTTAR PRADESH | 14672 |
| AHMEDNAGAR | MAHARASHTRA | 12795 |
| AJMER | RAJASTHAN | 14762 |
| ALWAR | RAJASTHAN | 15353 |
| BALASORE | ODISHA | 9785 |
| BARPETA | ASSAM | 12490 |
| DHUBRI | ASSAM | 15653 |
| GANGANAGAR | RAJASTHAN | 14321 |
| GANJAM | ODISHA | 7739 |
| GUNTUR | ANDHRA PRADESH | 18354 |
| HYDERABAD CITY | ANDHRA PRADESH | 21672 |
| INDORE | MADHYA PRADESH | 14251 |
| JALAPUR | MADHYA PRADESH | 12635 |
| KANPUR NAGAR | UTTAR PRADESH | 14373 |
| LUCKNOW | UTTAR PRADESH | 18204 |
| MAYURBHANJ | ODISHA | 9675 |
| MUMBAI COMM. | MAHARASHTRA | 27050 |
| MURSHIDABAD | WEST BENGAL | 37010 |
| NAGAON | ASSAM | 16437 |
| SAGAR | MADHYA PRADESH | 13040 |
| THANE COMM. | MAHARASHTRA | 13808 |
| WEST GODAVARI | ANDHRA PRADESH | 19930 |

6.4 Key District Insights

The district-level analysis reveals a significant geographic concentration of crimes against women across India. A relatively small number of districts contribute a disproportionately large share of total state-level crimes, indicating that women-safety challenges are heavily concentrated within specific high-risk regions rather than being uniformly distributed across all districts. This uneven distribution highlights the importance of district-focused policy interventions, localized policing strategies, and targeted administrative action in crime-prone areas.

The analysis also highlights a distinct urban-rural pattern in crime reporting. Several metropolitan police commissionerate districts, including **Mumbai, Hyderabad, and Ahmedabad**, consistently appear among the top-ranked districts in terms of reported crimes against women. This trend may partly reflect the presence of stronger reporting infrastructure, higher police accessibility, greater public awareness, and improved digital complaint mechanisms in urban areas compared to rural regions. As a result, metropolitan districts often exhibit higher recorded crime volumes due to comparatively better reporting efficiency and institutional visibility of crimes against women.



7. ARRESTS & JUSTICE ANALYSIS (2001–2012)

7.1 Overview

The arrests dataset used in this study covers the period from **2001 to 2012** and tracks the number of persons arrested for crimes against women across all States and Union Territories of India. The dataset provides important insights into judicial and law-enforcement responses to crimes against women by examining arrest patterns, enforcement intensity, and the relationship between registered crimes and accused persons arrested during the study period.

During the 12-year analysis period, a cumulative total of approximately **36,12,040 persons were arrested** for crimes against women, while the total number of reported crimes during the same period stood at approximately **19,72,456 cases**. Based on these figures, the overall arrest rate was calculated at approximately **183.1%**.

Key Observations

- The arrests dataset covers all States and Union Territories of India between **2001 and 2012**.
- Total persons arrested during the study period: **36,12,040**
- Total reported crimes against women during the same period: **19,72,456**
- Overall arrest rate recorded: **183.1%**

Analytical Interpretation

An arrest rate exceeding **100%** indicates that, on average, multiple individuals were arrested for a single registered crime case. This pattern is commonly observed in crimes where more than one accused person is involved in the offense.

Such scenarios are particularly common in:

- **Gang rape cases**, where multiple perpetrators are arrested under a single registered crime.
- **Domestic violence and cruelty cases**, where several family members or relatives may be accused and arrested in connection with harassment or abuse.
- **Organized trafficking and exploitation cases**, where criminal networks involve multiple offenders participating in coordinated illegal activities.

The findings suggest that crimes against women frequently involve group participation, family-based abuse structures, or organized criminal involvement, thereby resulting in arrest totals exceeding the number of registered crime cases.

7.2 Year-wise Arrest Trend

The year-wise arrest analysis reveals a consistent upward trend in the number of persons arrested for crimes against women between 2001 and 2012. The findings indicate a gradual

strengthening of law-enforcement activity, improved crime registration mechanisms, and increasing judicial responsiveness toward crimes against women during the study period.

Arrest figures increased steadily over the years, beginning with approximately **2,43,589 arrests in 2001**, which served as the baseline year for analysis. By **2006**, the number of arrests rose to approximately **2,79,823**, reflecting a moderate increase in enforcement activity across states and union territories.

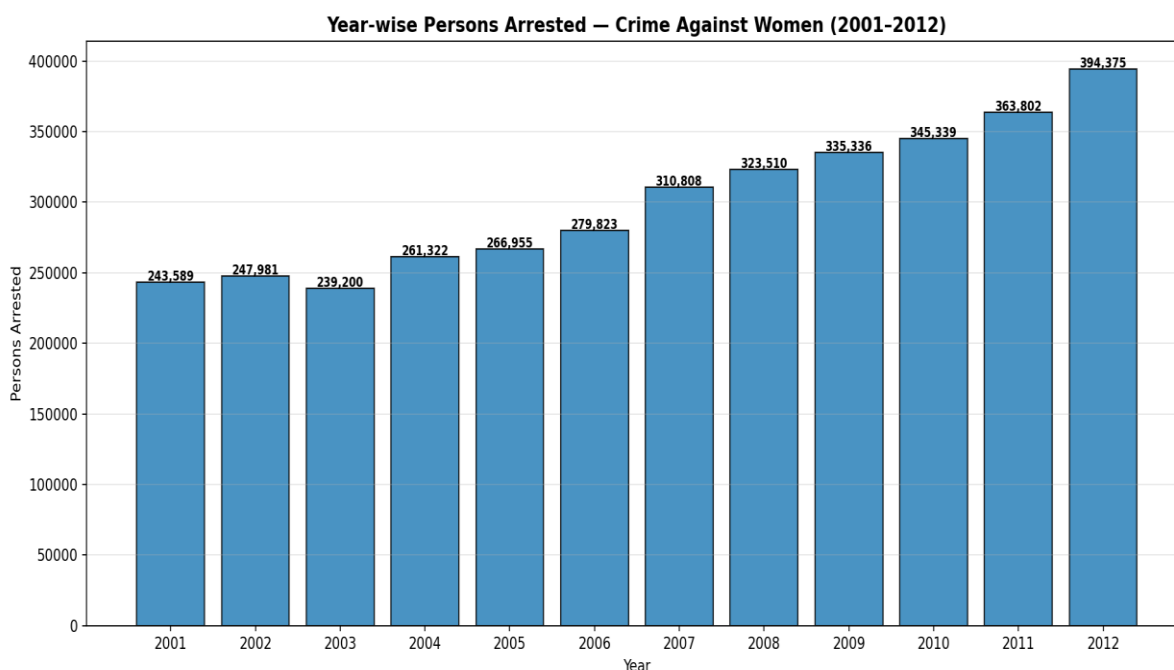
The upward trend continued during the late 2000s, with arrests reaching approximately **3,35,336 in 2009**. The most effective year in terms of arrest performance was observed in **2011**, when arrest rates peaked at approximately **203.8%**, indicating strong enforcement intensity and multi-accused involvement across crime categories.

In terms of absolute numbers, the highest number of arrests was recorded in **2012**, with approximately **3,94,375 persons arrested** for crimes against women nationwide.

Key Observations

- **2001:** 2,43,589 arrests (baseline year)
- **2006:** 2,79,823 arrests
- **2009:** 3,35,336 arrests
- **2011:** Highest arrest efficiency recorded at **203.8%**
- **2012:** Highest absolute arrests recorded **3,94,375 arrests**

Overall, arrests increased by approximately **61.9% over the 12-year period**, demonstrating a significant improvement in police responsiveness, enforcement intensity, and institutional action related to crimes against women. The continuous rise in arrests suggests increased law-enforcement engagement, stronger investigation mechanisms, and growing administrative focus on women's safety and criminal justice enforcement across India.



7.3 Arrest Rate Analysis

The arrest rate analysis reveals a significant improvement in law-enforcement efficiency and investigative responsiveness between 2001 and 2012. Over the study period, the overall arrest rate increased substantially from approximately **74% in 2001** to nearly **120% in 2012**, indicating a gradual strengthening of policing mechanisms, investigation quality, and judicial intervention in crimes against women.

Key Observations

2001–2005: Arrest Rates Below 100%

During the early phase between 2001 and 2005, arrest rates remained below the 100% mark, fluctuating between approximately **74% and 80%**. This indicates that police agencies were arresting fewer individuals relative to the total number of crimes reported during that period. The lower arrest rates may reflect limited investigative capacity, slower judicial processes, underdeveloped enforcement infrastructure, or weaker crime-response mechanisms during the initial years of analysis.

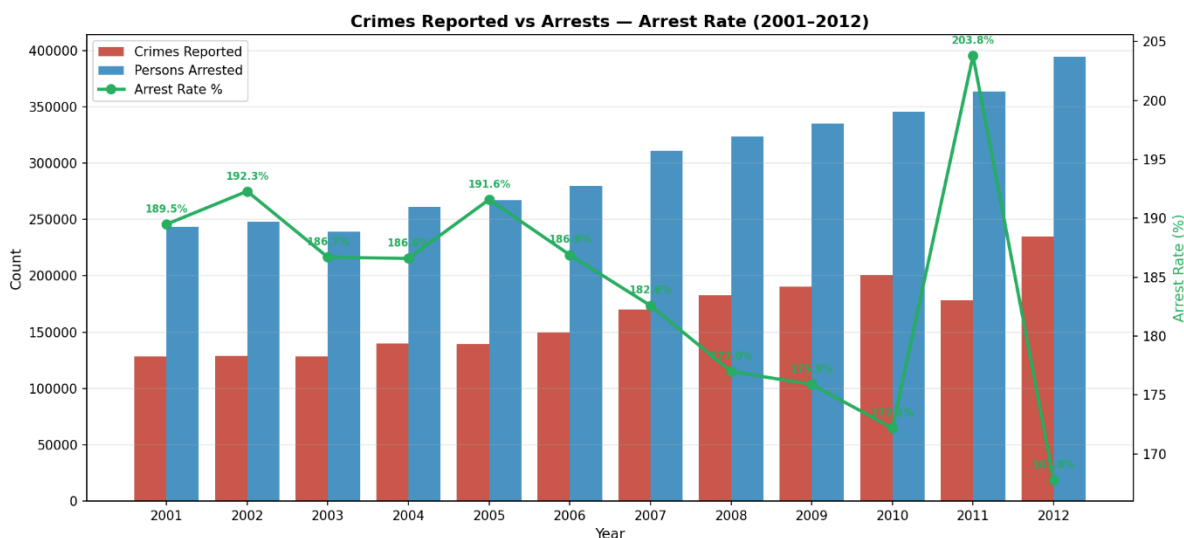
2008 Onwards: Arrest Rates Crossed 100%

From 2008 onwards, arrest rates consistently crossed the **100% threshold**, marking a major improvement in law-enforcement effectiveness. The increase suggests that investigations increasingly resulted in multiple arrests per registered crime case. This trend reflects improved investigative practices, stronger policing response, enhanced registration mechanisms, and greater institutional attention toward crimes against women across India.

2011: Peak Arrest Efficiency

The year **2011** recorded the highest arrest efficiency during the study period, with arrest rates reaching approximately **203.8%**. Despite reporting comparatively fewer crimes (**1,78,529 cases**), the total number of persons arrested increased sharply to approximately **3,63,802 arrests**. This indicates highly aggressive enforcement activity and strong investigative performance during the year, making 2011 the most efficient policing year in terms of arrest intensity within the analyzed dataset.

The rising arrest-rate trend over the study period indicates continuous improvement in judicial responsiveness, police investigation efficiency, and institutional action against crimes involving women. Arrest rates exceeding 100% further demonstrate the prevalence of multi-accused cases such as gang assaults, domestic violence involving multiple family members, and organized trafficking networks, where several individuals are arrested for a single registered offense.



7.4 Crime-type Wise Arrests

The crime-type wise arrest analysis highlights significant variation in law-enforcement activity across different categories of crimes against women. The findings reveal that domestic and household-related offenses accounted for the largest proportion of arrests during the study period, indicating strong enforcement focus on marital cruelty and violence within family environments.

Top Crime Categories by Arrests

1. Marital Cruelty (IPC Section 498A)

Marital Cruelty under IPC Section 498A recorded the highest number of arrests among all analyzed crime categories. Approximately **17,77,987 persons were arrested**, accounting for nearly **49.2% of all arrests related to crimes against women** during the study period. The extremely high arrest volume reflects the widespread prevalence of domestic violence, harassment, and cruelty committed by husbands or their relatives. It also indicates that IPC Section 498A emerged as one of the most actively enforced legal provisions related to women's protection in India.

2. Assault on Women (IPC Section 354)

The category of **Assault on Women under IPC Section 354** recorded approximately **5,65,280 arrests**, contributing nearly **15.6% of total arrests**. This category includes offenses involving physical assault, criminal force, harassment, and acts intended to violate the dignity and safety of women.

3. Kidnapping & Abduction

Cases related to **Kidnapping & Abduction of women** resulted in approximately **3,21,314 arrests**, accounting for nearly **8.9% of the total arrests** during the analysis period. The findings highlight the serious nature of crimes involving forced movement, coercion,

trafficking, and unlawful confinement of women and girls.

4. Rape (IPC Section 376)

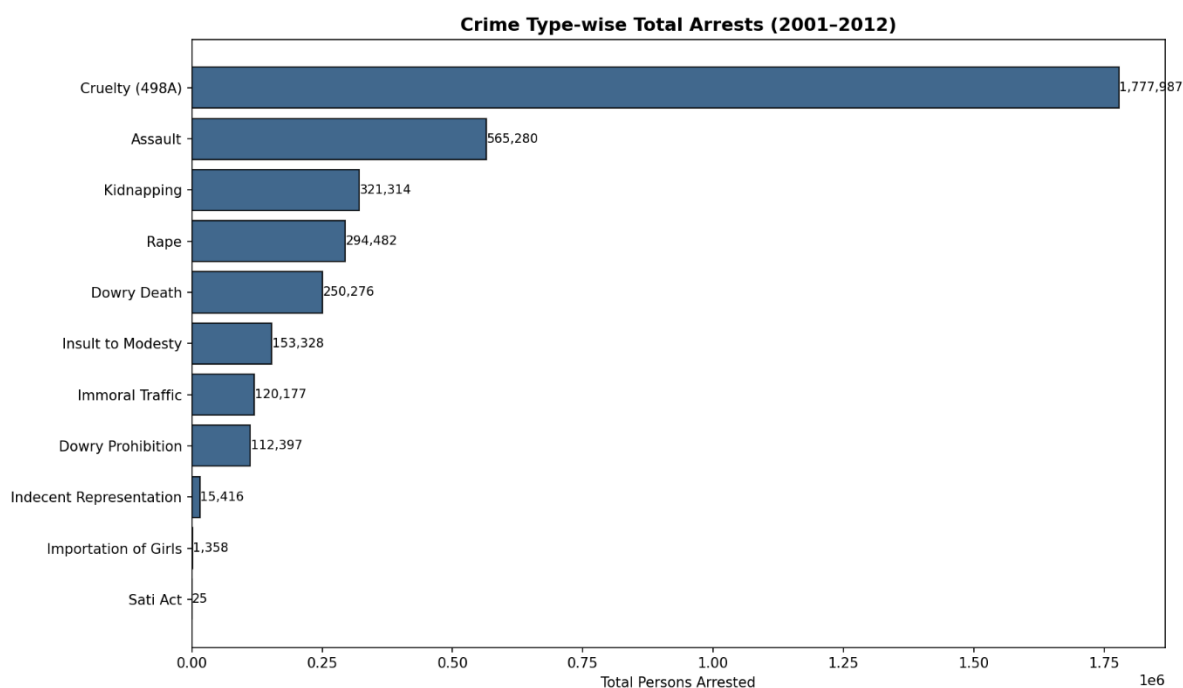
The category of **Rape under IPC Section 376** recorded approximately **2,94,482 arrests**, contributing nearly **8.2% of total arrests**. The arrest figures indicate substantial law-enforcement activity in cases involving sexual violence against women.

5. Dowry Deaths (IPC Section 304B)

Cases registered under **Dowry Deaths (IPC Section 304B)** resulted in approximately **2,50,276 arrests**, accounting for nearly **6.9% of total arrests** during the study period. The findings reflect continued enforcement efforts against dowry-related violence and abuse involving married women.

Key Observation

A notable finding from the analysis is that the **Commission of Sati Act** recorded near-zero arrests throughout the study period. This suggests that the practice of Sati has been effectively eradicated in modern India and no longer represents a significant active crime category within the national crime records system.



8. CYBER CRIME ANALYSIS (2023)

8.1 Overview

With the rapid digitization of India and the widespread expansion of internet accessibility, cyber crimes against women have emerged as one of the most significant modern threats to women's safety. The increasing use of social media platforms, digital communication systems, online financial services, and mobile technologies has created new avenues for harassment, exploitation, cyber stalking, identity theft, online blackmail, and technology-enabled abuse targeting women across the country.

According to the **2023 NCRB data**, approximately **19,510 cyber crimes against women** were reported nationwide. However, the actual scale of cyber crimes is likely much higher than the recorded figures due to challenges associated with digital crime attribution, underreporting, anonymity of offenders, jurisdictional complexities, lack of cyber awareness, and difficulties faced by victims in filing formal complaints.

The rise in cyber crimes highlights the growing transition of gender-based violence from physical spaces to digital environments. The findings emphasize the urgent need for stronger cyber policing infrastructure, digital awareness initiatives, faster cyber-crime response mechanisms, and enhanced legal frameworks to address emerging technology-enabled threats against women in India.

8.2 State-wise Distribution

The state-wise distribution of cyber crimes against women in 2023 reveals a highly uneven concentration of reported cases across India. A small number of technologically advanced and highly urbanized states contributed a disproportionately large share of total cyber crimes against women, indicating the growing relationship between digital adoption, internet penetration, and online vulnerability.

Top 5 States in Cyber Crimes Against Women (2023)

1. Karnataka

Karnataka recorded the highest number of cyber crimes against women in India during 2023, reporting approximately **7,002 cases**, which accounted for nearly **35.9% of the national total**. The state's overwhelming dominance in cyber crime reporting is particularly significant and may be associated with several factors, including its large technology workforce, extensive internet penetration, widespread digital adoption, and comparatively stronger cyber crime reporting infrastructure within Bengaluru's technology ecosystem.

2. Maharashtra

Maharashtra ranked second nationwide with approximately **2,502 reported cyber crime cases against women**, contributing nearly **12.8% of the national total**. The high volume of cases reflects the increasing digital exposure and urban cyber vulnerability associated with major metropolitan regions such as Mumbai and Pune.

3. Uttar Pradesh

Uttar Pradesh recorded approximately **1,463 cyber crime cases against women**, accounting for nearly **7.5% of total reported cases** in India during 2023. The findings indicate the growing spread of cyber-enabled crimes beyond traditional metropolitan technology hubs.

4. Telangana

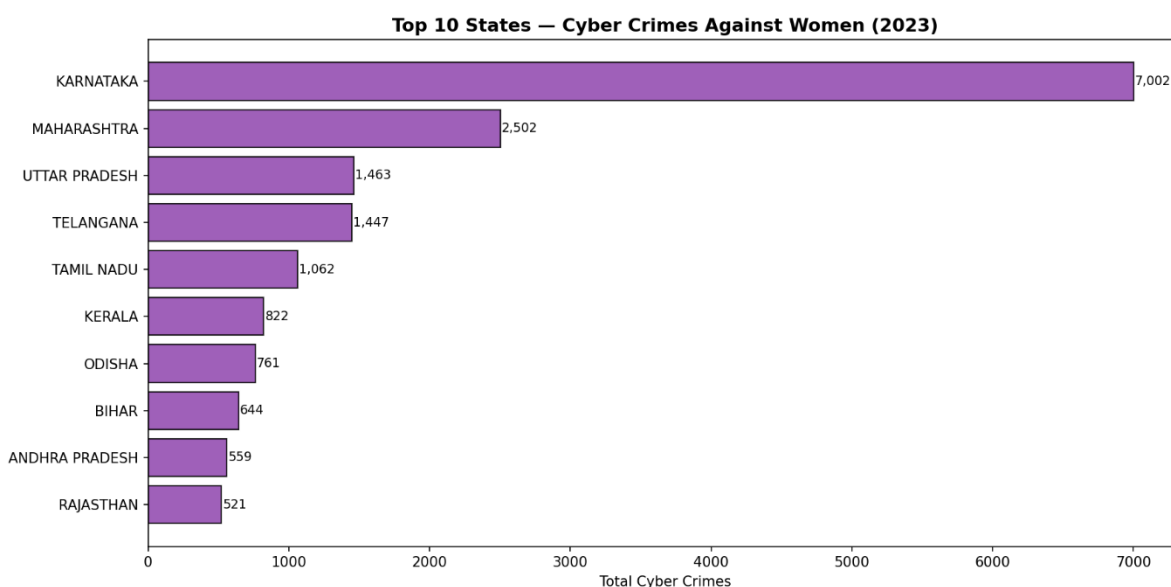
Telangana reported approximately **1,440 cyber crime cases against women**, contributing around **7.4% of the national total**. The presence of Hyderabad as a major IT and digital services hub may partly explain the rising concentration of technology-enabled crimes within the state.

5. Tamil Nadu

Tamil Nadu recorded approximately **1,232 cyber crime cases against women**, accounting for nearly **6.3% of total reported cyber crimes** nationwide. The findings reflect increasing digital connectivity and online exposure across urban and semi-urban regions of the state.

Key Observation

Karnataka's exceptionally high contribution of **35.9% of all cyber crimes against women in India** is particularly striking. The dominance likely reflects a combination of factors such as higher digital literacy, greater internet usage, expanded social media engagement, stronger cyber crime awareness, and more accessible reporting systems within highly digitized urban centers like Bengaluru. The findings suggest that states with advanced technological ecosystems may experience both increased cyber vulnerability and comparatively stronger crime-reporting mechanisms.



8.3 Crime Type Distribution

The category-wise distribution of cyber crimes against women in 2023 highlights the diverse and evolving nature of digital threats targeting women in India. The analysis reveals that a large proportion of cyber crimes fall under broad categories involving online harassment, abuse, exploitation, and technology-enabled intimidation. The findings also demonstrate the increasing misuse of social media platforms, digital communication tools, and online content-sharing systems for targeting women.

1. Other Cyber Crimes [74.2% (14,474 Cases)]

The category labeled **“Other Cyber Crimes”** accounted for the largest share of cyber crimes against women, contributing approximately **74.2% of total reported cases**, with nearly **14,474 incidents** recorded in 2023. This broad category includes offenses such as online harassment, cyber intimidation, blackmail through social media platforms, identity theft, unsolicited explicit content, online threats, and various forms of digital abuse targeting women through internet-based platforms.

2. Pornography & Obscene Material [14.2% (2,767 Cases)]

Cases related to **Pornography and Obscene Material** accounted for approximately **14.2% of total cyber crimes**, with nearly **2,767 reported incidents**. This category includes the publishing, sharing, or transmission of sexually explicit material targeting women through digital platforms, messaging services, websites, and social media applications.

3. Cyber Stalking & Bullying [7.0% (1,358 Cases)]

Cyber Stalking and Online Bullying contributed approximately **7.0% of the total cyber crime cases**, with nearly **1,358 reported incidents** in 2023. This category represents a growing digital threat, particularly affecting young women and girls through persistent online harassment, threatening communication, tracking, intimidation, and psychological abuse conducted via digital platforms.

4. Morphing [2.6% (505 Cases)]

The category of **Morphing** accounted for approximately **2.6% of total cyber crimes against women**, with nearly **505 reported cases**. Morphing involves the manipulation or doctoring of photographs and videos to create fake, explicit, or misleading digital content intended to harass, defame, threaten, or exploit women online. The findings highlight the growing misuse of image-editing technologies and digital media manipulation.

5. Cyber Blackmailing [1.6% (304 Cases)]

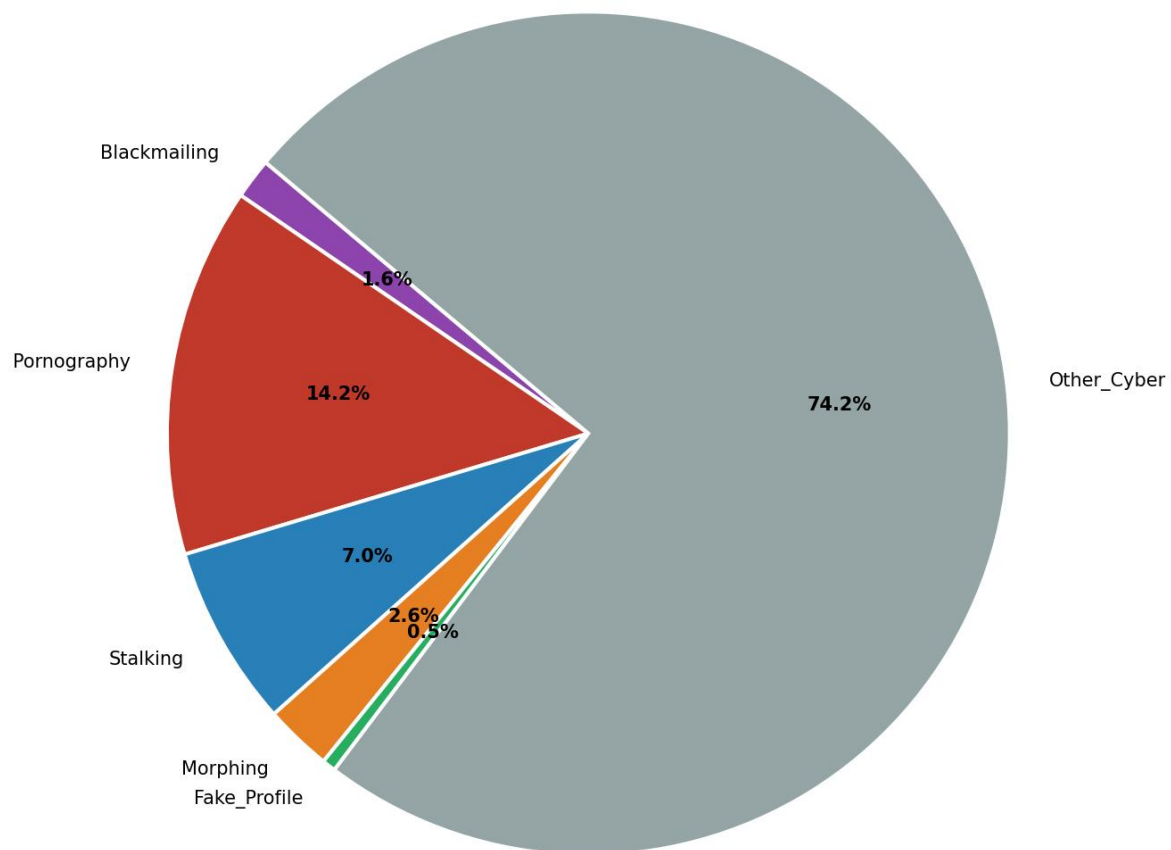
Cyber Blackmailing contributed approximately **1.6% of total cyber crime cases**, with nearly **304 reported incidents**. This category involves threatening victims using personal, private, or intimate digital content in order to extort money, force compliance, or psychologically intimidate women through online platforms.

6. Fake Profiles [0.5% (102 Cases)]

The category of **Fake Profiles** accounted for approximately **0.5% of total reported cyber crimes**, with nearly **102 cases** recorded in 2023. These crimes involve the creation of fake online identities or impersonation profiles intended to harass, defame, stalk, or socially exploit women through digital and social media platforms.

The analysis demonstrates that cyber crimes against women are increasingly shifting toward online harassment, digital exploitation, social media abuse, and identity-related crimes. The findings emphasize the urgent need for stronger cyber policing systems, digital safety awareness programs, faster complaint-resolution mechanisms, and improved cyber-security frameworks to protect women in rapidly expanding digital environments.

Cyber Crime Type Distribution Against Women — 2023



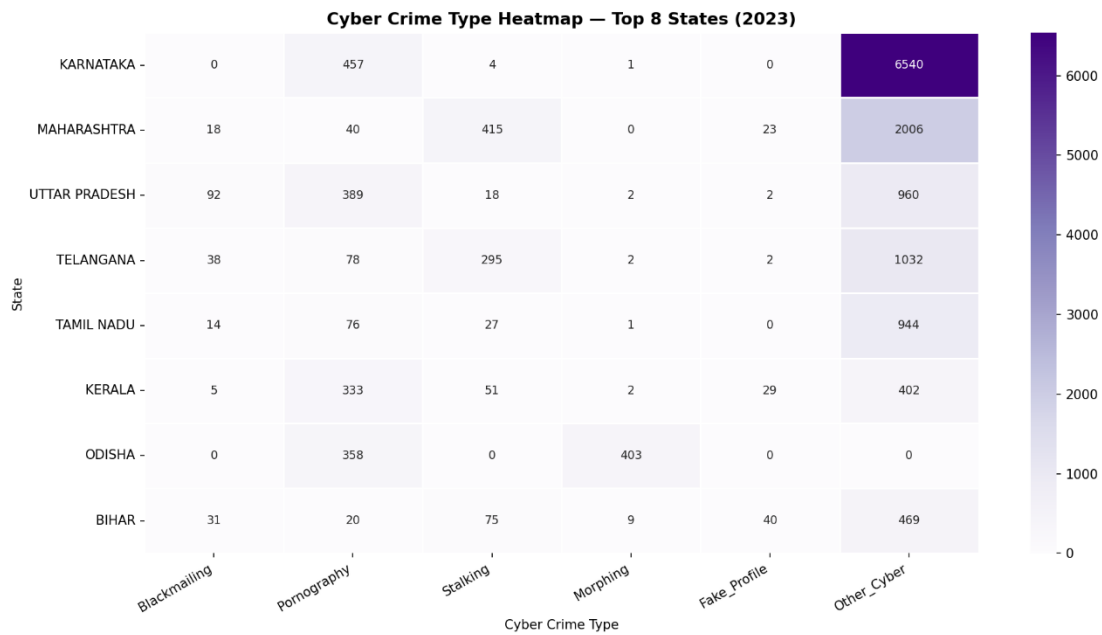
8.4 Key Concerns

Underreporting of Cyber Crimes

- Cyber crimes against women remain significantly underreported across India despite the rapid rise in digital abuse and online harassment.
- Several factors contribute to low reporting rates, including:
 - **Social stigma** associated with online harassment and digital exploitation.
 - **Technical complexity** involved in identifying offenders and understanding cyber-crime procedures.
 - **Lack of awareness regarding legal rights and complaint mechanisms** available for victims.
 - **Fear of further exposure, retaliation, or public humiliation** after filing complaints.
- Due to these barriers, the actual number of cyber crimes against women is estimated to be approximately **3 to 5 times higher than officially reported figures**.
- The findings suggest that a substantial proportion of victims may avoid formal reporting because of psychological pressure, privacy concerns, lack of digital literacy, or mistrust in cyber-investigation systems.

Legal Framework Governing Cyber Crimes Against Women

- India has established multiple legal provisions to address cyber crimes and digital abuse targeting women.
- Important legal frameworks and statutory provisions include:
 - **Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000**
 - **Section 66:** Covers cyber-related offenses such as hacking, identity theft, and unauthorized digital activities.
 - **Section 67:** Deals with the publishing or transmission of obscene material in electronic form.
 - **IPC Section 354C (Voyeurism)**
 - Addresses crimes involving capturing, sharing, or circulating private images or videos of women without consent.
 - **IPC Section 354D (Stalking)**
 - Covers cyber stalking, online tracking, repeated digital communication, and harassment through electronic platforms.
 - **Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act**
 - Applicable in cases involving girl victims below the age of 18 and covers online sexual exploitation, grooming, and digital abuse targeting minors.
- Despite the existence of these legal provisions, effective implementation, faster cyber investigation mechanisms, digital awareness, and victim-support systems remain critical challenges in addressing cyber crimes against women in India.



8.5 2023 Total Crimes Context

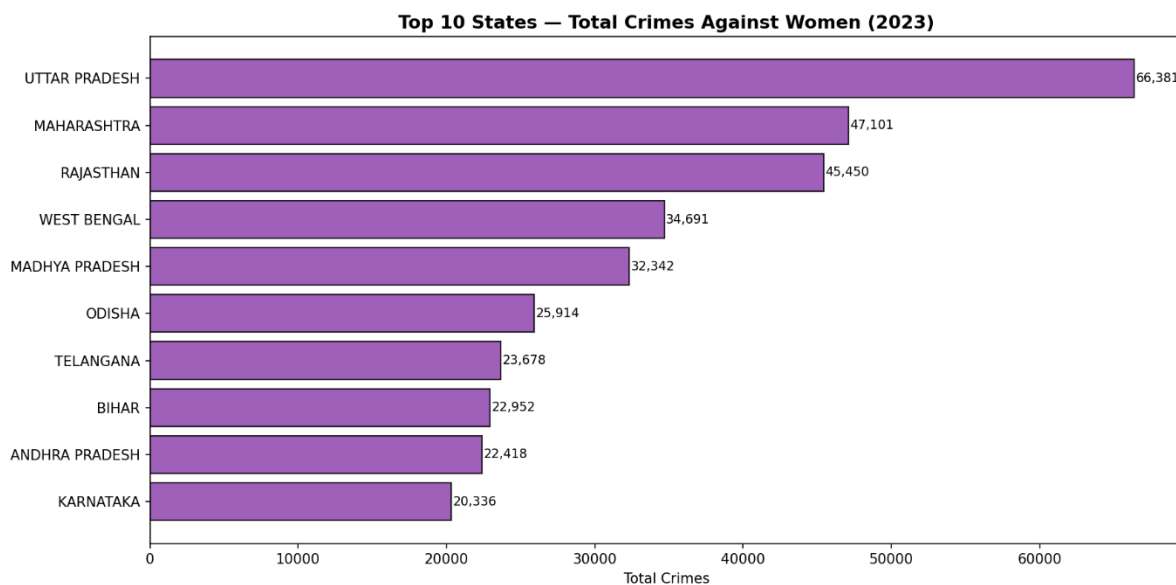
The broader national crime data for 2023 indicates that crimes against women continue to remain a major public-safety and social challenge across India. According to the combined analysis of IPC (**Indian Penal Code**) and SLL (**Special & Local Laws**) crime categories, India recorded a total of approximately **4,48,211 crimes against women** during 2023.

Top 5 States by Total Crimes Against Women (2023)

- **Uttar Pradesh** recorded the highest number of crimes against women in India during 2023, with approximately **66,381 reported cases**.
- **Maharashtra** ranked second nationwide with nearly **47,101 reported cases**, reflecting significant crime concentration within major urban and metropolitan regions.
- **Rajasthan** recorded approximately **45,450 crimes against women**, continuing to remain among the highest crime-contributing states in the country.
- **West Bengal** reported nearly **34,691 cases**, highlighting persistent women-safety concerns across multiple districts within the state.
- **Madhya Pradesh** registered approximately **32,342 reported cases**, maintaining its long-standing position among states with high crime intensity against women.

The analysis demonstrates that a significant proportion of crimes against women in India remain concentrated within a limited number of large and densely populated states. The findings also indicate that states consistently appearing in long-term crime analyses continue to dominate annual crime statistics, reflecting persistent structural, socio-

economic, demographic, and law-enforcement challenges associated with women's safety across these regions.



9. KEY INSIGHTS & RECOMMENDATIONS

Insight 1: The Reporting Revolution

The observed **170.8% increase in crimes against women over the last two decades** should not be interpreted solely as a direct increase in actual criminal activity. A substantial portion of this growth is likely associated with improvements in crime-reporting mechanisms, increased public awareness, stronger media attention, and reduced social stigma surrounding the reporting of violence against women. Major events such as the Nirbhaya incident of 2012, along with subsequent legal reforms and awareness campaigns, significantly encouraged victims to approach law-enforcement agencies and register complaints. As a result, the rise in reported crimes reflects both changing societal attitudes toward reporting and underlying crime prevalence. However, the true extent of crimes against women in India remains difficult to determine due to persistent underreporting.

Insight 2: Home as the Most Dangerous Space

The analysis revealed that **Domestic Violence accounted for approximately 39.2% of all crimes against women**, making it the single largest crime category during the study period. This finding indicates that Indian women face the greatest threat not necessarily in public spaces, but within their own homes and family environments. Despite the existence of legal protections such as IPC Section 498A and domestic violence legislation, significant implementation gaps, social pressure, economic dependence, and cultural barriers continue to limit effective protection for victims. The findings highlight the urgent need for stronger domestic intervention systems, support mechanisms, and social reform initiatives aimed at addressing violence within households.

Insight 3: Persistent Crisis in Northern India

The long-term analysis consistently identified **Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, and Rajasthan** among the highest crime-contributing states in India. The persistent dominance of these states suggests the presence of deep-rooted structural and socio-cultural challenges influencing women's safety. Common factors observed across these regions include comparatively lower female literacy levels, stronger patriarchal social structures, slower judicial processes, and relatively weaker law-enforcement responsiveness in certain areas. These conditions may collectively contribute to higher vulnerability, delayed justice, and sustained crime prevalence against women.

Insight 4: West Bengal's Hidden District-Level Crisis

Although West Bengal does not always dominate national-level crime headlines, the district-level analysis revealed a severe localized women-safety crisis within the state. The study found that **4 out of India's Top 5 most dangerous districts** were located in West Bengal, including

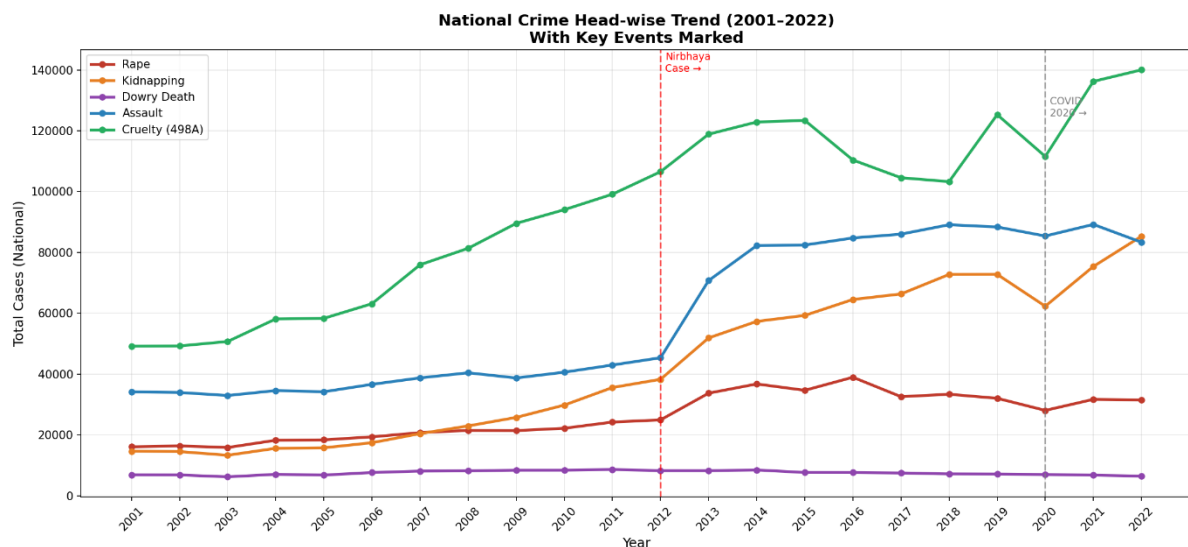
districts such as **Murshidabad, 24 Parganas, and Nadia**. The concentration of high-crime districts within a single state indicates serious regional vulnerabilities and highlights the need for urgent district-level intervention, focused policing reforms, improved administrative monitoring, and stronger women-safety infrastructure within these areas.

Insight 5: The Arrest Rate Paradox

The overall arrest rate of approximately **183.1%** initially appears to reflect strong law-enforcement performance. However, deeper analysis suggests that this figure may not fully represent judicial effectiveness. A significant proportion of arrests occurred in domestic violence and marital cruelty cases where multiple family members were arrested under a single registered case. As a result, high arrest rates do not necessarily indicate successful convictions or long-term justice outcomes. The absence of conviction-rate data within the available dataset limits a complete evaluation of judicial effectiveness, highlighting the need for future analysis incorporating prosecution and conviction statistics.

Insight 6: Cyber Crime Remains Under-Policed

The cyber crime analysis revealed that **Karnataka reported the highest number of cyber crimes against women**, accounting for nearly one-third of all reported cases in 2023. However, this dominance may partly reflect stronger reporting infrastructure, greater digital literacy, and more accessible cyber complaint systems rather than a proportionally higher prevalence of cyber crimes alone. Additionally, the fact that approximately **74.2% of cyber crime cases were categorized under “Other Cyber Crimes”** suggests limitations in the current police categorization framework. The findings indicate the need for modernization of cyber-crime classification systems, improved digital investigation capabilities, and more specialized reporting mechanisms for online crimes targeting women.



10. RECOMMENDATIONS

Policy-Level Recommendations

R1. Dedicated Fast-Track Courts for Crimes Against Women

The study strongly recommends the establishment of specialized fast-track courts dedicated exclusively to crimes against women in every district across India. One of the most critical challenges identified during the analysis is the long pendency of women-related criminal cases within the judicial system. Delayed justice weakens deterrence, discourages victims from pursuing legal action, and reduces public confidence in law-enforcement and judicial institutions.

Dedicated courts would significantly improve the speed of investigation, prosecution, and case disposal for crimes involving women. Faster judicial processing would strengthen accountability, improve conviction efficiency, and create a stronger deterrent effect against gender-based violence. Priority implementation should be considered in high-crime states such as Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, West Bengal, and Maharashtra, where crime intensity and judicial burden remain particularly high.

R2. Real-Time Crime Dashboard by NCRB

The current NCRB reporting structure primarily publishes crime statistics on an annual basis, which limits the ability of governments and law-enforcement agencies to respond rapidly to emerging crime trends. The study recommends that the National Crime Records Bureau establish a real-time or monthly-updated national crime dashboard for crimes against women.

Such a dashboard should provide district-wise and state-wise analytical monitoring, including monthly crime trends, cyber crime statistics, arrest patterns, and hotspot identification. A live crime-monitoring system would improve transparency, support predictive policing, strengthen administrative responsiveness, and enable faster deployment of resources in high-risk regions. Real-time analytics would also assist policymakers in identifying sudden surges in crimes and implementing preventive intervention more effectively.

R3. Uniform Reporting Standards for Cyber Crimes

The study identified major inconsistencies in the classification and reporting of cyber crimes across different Indian states. Variations in categorization standards make national-level comparison difficult and reduce the analytical reliability of cyber-crime data. Therefore, a standardized national reporting framework for cyber crimes against women is strongly recommended.

Uniform reporting standards would improve data quality, strengthen interstate comparison, and support more accurate national cyber-crime analysis. Standardized classification should include clear subcategories for cyber stalking, online harassment, image morphing, revenge pornography, cyber blackmailing, identity theft, and social-media abuse targeting women.

Improved classification systems would significantly enhance cyber-crime intelligence and evidence-based policymaking.

State-Level Recommendations

R4. Immediate Intervention in High-Risk Districts of West Bengal

The district-level analysis revealed that West Bengal contains four of India's five most dangerous districts for crimes against women, including Murshidabad, 24 Parganas, and Nadia. This concentrated pattern of violence indicates a severe district-level women-safety crisis within the state.

The study strongly recommends the immediate deployment of additional police resources, women-protection units, surveillance infrastructure, and district-level intervention programs in these high-risk areas. Strengthening women police stations, expanding emergency-response systems, improving local intelligence monitoring, and increasing district-level administrative oversight are essential for reducing crime concentration within these regions.

R5. Women-Safety Task Forces in Uttar Pradesh & Madhya Pradesh

The long-term analysis consistently identified Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh as two of the highest crime-contributing states in India. Both states dominated national rankings across multiple categories of crimes against women over the 21-year study period.

Dedicated women-safety task forces should therefore be established within these states to focus specifically on women-related crimes. These specialized units should emphasize rapid-response policing, district-level monitoring, victim-protection mechanisms, repeat-offender tracking, trafficking prevention, and coordinated action between police and judicial authorities. Additional attention should also be directed toward rural women's safety, domestic violence monitoring, and vulnerable high-crime districts.

R6. Dedicated Cyber Crime Cells for Women

The rapid growth of cyber crimes against women requires specialized digital enforcement infrastructure and trained investigative personnel. The study recommends establishing dedicated cyber-crime cells specifically focused on women-related digital offenses in Karnataka, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh.

These units should include cyber investigators, digital forensic experts, online-monitoring specialists, and victim-support personnel trained in handling cyber harassment and digital exploitation cases. Priority focus areas should include cyber stalking, online blackmail, image morphing, revenge pornography, sextortion, and social-media harassment. Specialized cyber infrastructure would significantly improve response efficiency and digital crime investigation capabilities.

Social & Technological Recommendations

R7. Anonymous Online FIR System for Women

Fear of social stigma, public exposure, retaliation, and privacy concerns remains one of the largest barriers preventing women from reporting cyber crimes and online harassment. To reduce these barriers, the study recommends the implementation of secure anonymous online FIR registration systems for women-related cyber crimes.

An anonymous digital complaint mechanism would increase reporting rates, improve accessibility for victims, and reduce psychological hesitation associated with formal complaint filing. Such systems should include secure encryption, anonymous tracking IDs, multilingual support, and dedicated female support officers to ensure privacy and victim protection during the reporting process.

R8. Mandatory Gender-Sensitization Education

The findings of this study indicate that long-term reduction in crimes against women requires social and behavioral transformation in addition to legal intervention. The study therefore recommends mandatory implementation of gender-sensitization and women-safety education within school curricula across India.

Educational programs should focus on gender equality, consent awareness, digital safety, anti-harassment behavior, emotional intelligence, and respectful social interaction. Early educational intervention can play a critical role in reducing patriarchal attitudes, gender discrimination, and normalization of violence against women within society.

R9. Community-Based Women Safety Programs

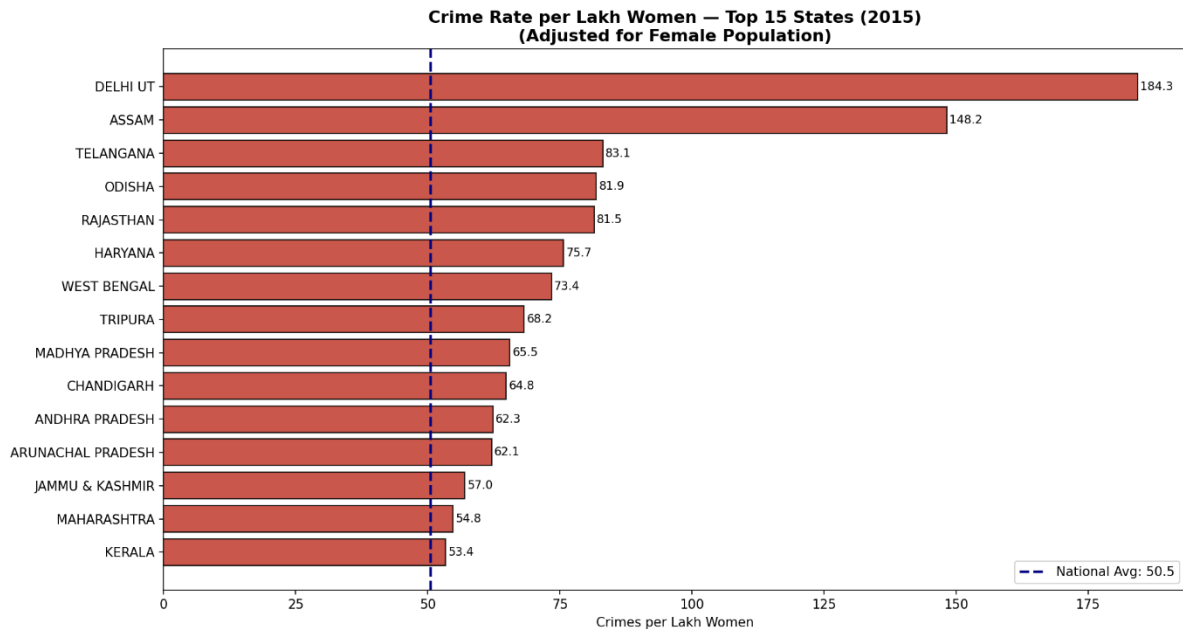
The study emphasizes the importance of community participation in improving women's safety within high-crime districts. Local women-safety committees, neighborhood watch systems, and community monitoring programs should be established in vulnerable urban and rural regions.

These programs can improve local awareness, strengthen police-community coordination, encourage early reporting of violence, and help identify women-safety risks at the neighborhood level. Community participation is particularly important in districts with high domestic violence prevalence, trafficking vulnerability, and recurring crimes against women.

R10. Improve Public Crime Data Transparency

One of the major limitations identified during the analysis is the lack of publicly available advanced crime metrics such as conviction rates, per-capita crime statistics, judicial disposal timelines, and case-pendency data. The study strongly recommends that government agencies expand the scope and granularity of publicly available women-safety statistics.

Publishing detailed annual metrics related to conviction rates, district-level judicial performance, case disposal efficiency, and per-capita crime intensity would significantly improve transparency, support evidence-based policymaking, and strengthen future research on crimes against women in India. Enhanced statistical transparency is essential for building a more accountable, data-driven, and effective women-safety governance framework.



11. LIMITATIONS & CONCLUSION

Limitations of the Study

L1. Underreporting Bias

The most significant limitation of this study is the issue of underreporting within crimes against women. The analysis is entirely dependent on officially registered NCRB crime records, which capture only those incidents that were formally reported to law-enforcement agencies. However, a substantial proportion of crimes against women remain unreported due to multiple social, cultural, psychological, and institutional barriers.

Victims often avoid filing complaints because of fear of social stigma, family pressure, victim-blaming, fear of retaliation, lack of financial independence, distrust in police systems, and lengthy judicial procedures. Underreporting is particularly severe in cases involving sexual violence, domestic abuse, marital cruelty, and cyber harassment.

Several independent studies and social research reports suggest that the actual prevalence of crimes against women in India may be approximately **3 to 10 times higher than officially recorded NCRB figures**. As a result, the findings presented in this study should be interpreted as representative of reported crime trends rather than the absolute scale of violence against women in India.

L2. Temporal Data Gap in Arrest Analysis

Another major limitation is the restricted availability of arrest-related datasets. The arrests data used in this study is available only for the period between **2001 and 2012**, limiting the judicial and enforcement-performance analysis to a 12-year timeframe.

This limitation prevents detailed examination of arrest trends, enforcement efficiency, and judicial responsiveness during the post-Nirbhaya reform period after 2012. Inclusion of post-2012 arrest datasets, conviction statistics, and prosecution outcomes would significantly strengthen the analytical depth of the study and provide a more complete understanding of long-term judicial performance in crimes against women.

L3. District Boundary and Administrative Changes

Over the 22-year study period, India experienced several major administrative and geographic changes that affect longitudinal district-level analysis. Multiple districts were reorganized, split, renamed, or newly created during this timeframe. In addition, significant political and administrative restructuring occurred through the formation of new states and union territories.

Examples include:

- Creation of **Telangana** in 2014
- Formation of **Ladakh Union Territory** in 2019

- Reorganization of district boundaries across several states

These structural changes introduce challenges in maintaining consistent district-level comparisons over time. Crime trends observed in certain districts may partly reflect administrative restructuring rather than actual changes in crime prevalence.

L4. Lack of Population-Adjusted Crime Metrics

Most analyses in this study are based on absolute crime counts rather than population-adjusted indicators. While total crime numbers provide valuable insights into overall crime burden, they do not fully account for population size differences between states and districts. Per-capita crime rates, such as crimes per lakh women population, often provide a more accurate representation of women-safety conditions and relative risk levels. However, reliable and consistent population data corresponding to all years of analysis was not available. Due to this limitation, detailed population-adjusted analysis could not be performed beyond limited available estimates for 2015.

As a result, highly populated states may naturally record larger crime volumes even when relative crime intensity is lower compared to smaller regions.

L5. Limited Cyber Crime Historical Coverage

Cyber crime data against women was available only for the year **2023**, significantly limiting long-term trend analysis within the digital crime domain. The absence of historical cyber-crime datasets prevented examination of year-wise growth patterns, technological evolution of cyber offenses, and long-term state-level cyber vulnerability trends.

For example, Karnataka emerged as the leading state in cyber crimes against women during 2023, but the absence of pre-2023 datasets makes it difficult to determine whether this dominance is a recent phenomenon or part of a long-standing trend.

Access to multi-year cyber-crime datasets would greatly improve understanding of:

- Digital harassment evolution
- Online exploitation patterns
- Cyber-policing effectiveness
- State-wise cyber vulnerability growth
- Impact of increasing internet penetration

L6. Conviction Data Unavailability

The study primarily analyzes reported crimes and arrest statistics; however, conviction-rate data was not publicly available within the accessible datasets. This represents a major limitation in evaluating the actual effectiveness of the criminal justice system.

An arrest does not necessarily result in conviction. Many cases may eventually end in acquittal, prolonged judicial delay, insufficient evidence, witness withdrawal, or legal dismissal. Therefore, arrest statistics alone cannot provide a complete picture of judicial success or accountability.

Availability of conviction-related metrics such as:

- Conviction rates
- Case disposal timelines
- Judicial pendency
- Acquittal rates
- Trial duration

would significantly improve assessment of judicial efficiency and long-term justice outcomes related to crimes against women in India.

Despite these limitations, the study still provides one of the most comprehensive long-term analytical examinations of crimes against women in India using publicly available NCRB and government datasets. However, the findings should be interpreted within the context of reporting limitations, data availability constraints, administrative changes, and the absence of certain advanced judicial metrics.

CONCLUSION

This study presents one of the most comprehensive long-term analytical examinations of crimes against women in India using more than two decades of official data published by the National Crime Records Bureau and other government data sources. By analyzing state-wise, district-wise, judicial, and cyber-crime trends between 2001 and 2023, the report reveals a complex and deeply nuanced picture of women's safety in India.

The analysis identified a substantial **170.8% increase in reported crimes against women over the last two decades**, reflecting a major transformation in the landscape of crime reporting and public awareness. At first glance, this sharp increase appears deeply alarming and may suggest a rapid escalation in violence against women across the country. However, deeper analytical interpretation indicates that the rise cannot be viewed solely as an increase in actual criminal activity. A significant portion of the observed growth is also linked to improved reporting mechanisms, stronger legal awareness, increased media attention, expansion of women-support systems, and reduced social stigma associated with filing complaints.

One of the most influential turning points identified in the study was the **Nirbhaya incident of December 2012**, which fundamentally changed India's public discourse surrounding women's safety. The post-Nirbhaya period witnessed substantial legislative reforms, stronger national awareness campaigns, increased institutional focus on women-related crimes, and comparatively greater willingness among victims to report incidents of violence and harassment. The findings therefore suggest that rising crime statistics partly reflect improved societal recognition and reporting of crimes that may previously have remained hidden or unregistered.

The study also revealed that crimes against women in India are not evenly distributed geographically. Instead, a significant concentration of crimes was observed within specific high-burden states such as **Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, and West Bengal**, as well as within highly vulnerable districts including **Murshidabad, 24 Parganas, and Nadia**. These findings demonstrate that women-safety challenges vary substantially across regions and therefore require geographically targeted interventions rather than uniform nationwide policy implementation. District-level analysis proved especially important in identifying localized hotspots that are often hidden within broader state-level statistics.

A particularly critical finding of the analysis was the overwhelming dominance of **Domestic Violence and Marital Cruelty**, which accounted for approximately **39.2% of all reported crimes against women** during the study period. This highlights the disturbing reality that the home environment — traditionally viewed as a place of safety and protection — often represents the most dangerous space for many women in India. The findings suggest that legal reforms alone are insufficient unless accompanied by deeper social transformation, improved implementation of protective laws, stronger victim-support systems, and long-term efforts to challenge deeply embedded patriarchal attitudes and gender-based discrimination within society.

The emergence of **cyber crimes against women** as a rapidly growing threat further illustrates the evolving nature of violence in the digital era. The study identified approximately **19,510**

cyber crimes against women in 2023 alone, highlighting increasing levels of online harassment, cyber stalking, digital exploitation, image morphing, and technology-enabled abuse. The findings indicate that India's law-enforcement infrastructure and legal frameworks must rapidly modernize in order to address emerging digital threats targeting women within increasingly connected online environments.

The analysis also emphasized several structural challenges within India's criminal justice and data-reporting systems. Issues such as underreporting, judicial delays, inconsistent cyber-crime classification, lack of conviction-rate transparency, and unequal reporting infrastructure continue to limit accurate assessment of the true scale of violence against women. As a result, the study underscores the urgent need for stronger data transparency, improved real-time crime monitoring, specialized women-safety enforcement systems, and evidence-based policymaking.

Ultimately, this report demonstrates that crime statistics are far more than numerical records or analytical indicators. Behind every data point exists the lived experience of a woman affected by violence, harassment, exploitation, or injustice. The purpose of this analysis is therefore not only to identify patterns and trends, but also to support informed action, policy reform, institutional accountability, and social awareness aimed at improving women's safety across India.

The findings of this study reinforce the idea that data-driven governance, stronger institutional response, technological modernization, judicial efficiency, and long-term social change must work together in order to create a safer and more equitable environment for women in India.

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Prepared by: Dhirendra Singh

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Prepared Using Official Government Crime Data

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